

# The Dhāraṇī for Protecting Oneself

Ātmarakṣā-dhāraṇī · Toh 791 · Derge Kangyur

བདག་བསང་བའ་གི་ཐད་སྤྱོད་

The Noble One Called "Pleasing to the Mind" is a short Buddhist dhāraṇī, a brief mantra-formula, whose Tibetan title begins with the honorific "Phagpa," meaning "noble." Its Sanskrit title is not given in the lines available here, so it is best known by its English rendering. The text opens with a short mantra honoring the Buddha and then sets out simple ritual uses of it, such as reciting it over substances like gorocana or over water. These are said to make one agreeable and welcome to others and to bring about affection and friendship. It is Toh 791 in the Kangyur, the canonical collection of the Buddha's teachings in Tibetan translation, where it belongs to the class of tantra and dhāraṇī literature, texts that offer protective and practical mantras.

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Svāhā. Looking toward the sun, recite this mantra seven times over water and scatter it in the ten directions; one will then be protected. This completes the dhāraṇī for protecting oneself.

The noble one called "Pleasing to the Mind."

Homage to the Buddha, the Blessed One.

Namo bhagavate. Uṣṇīṣāya dhāre dharaṇatiye svāhā.

It succeeds merely by being recited, even without a formal practice of accomplishment. If one recites it one hundred and eight times over gorocana and marks the forehead with a dot, one becomes pleasing to the minds of all. If one recites the mantra over tītsala and applies it to the eyes, whomever one looks upon will be agreeable and meet one's gaze. If one recites it over water and drinks it, others will give one food and will feel affection and wish for one's company.

This completes the dhāraṇī of "Pleasing to the Mind."

## Translator's Notes

- The first lines belong to the preceding text, the dhāraṇī for protecting oneself, and are rendered as given. The mantra is a transliteration and is given as the Tibetan renders it; its Sanskrit is corrupt and uncertain, so the form is only a tentative reconstruction. The Tibetan "giu wang" is gorocana, a yellow pigment traditionally obtained from cattle. "Tītsala" is the Tibetan transliteration of an unidentified substance, probably a medicinal or cosmetic ingredient, and is left untranslated. The final clause about food and "snying 'dod" is brief and

slightly elliptical; I have taken it to mean that others become fond of the person and wish for their company.

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## **Colophon**

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.